

General Setup

- **Galactic Board:** competitive or **coop/solo**, with 1/1/2/2 *trade tokens* on each of the top 5/6/5/6 spaces.
- **Agenda Board:** place agenda cards in 4 face-down piles on the left, with 1 card face-up on the right.
- **Combat Tile(s):** place the main *combat tile* and add later the other tiles for the chosen technologies.
- **1st Player:** choose randomly and place turn order tracks on the galactic board in clockwise order.
- **Harbingers:** take 7/8/10/10 from the box for 1/2/3/4P.
- **Difficulty:** choose setup aid card for .
- **Crisis Board:** place 3 *catastrophe tokens* nearby.
 - **Initial Crisis:** place one 0-crisis card on each row if , as per the setup aid card.
- **Crisis Cards:** shuffle each deck and place face-down.
- **Alert Deck:** setup according to the setup aid card.
 - **War Alert Cards:** shuffle cards for chosen difficulty, separately, face-down. Each is used only once.
- **Focus Deck**
 - Shuffle the *joint focus cards* (1P: *heroic focus cards*).
 - Flip 3 face-up below the crisis board (*Innovation* should be replaced and go back on top of deck).



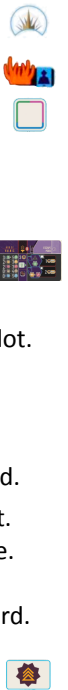
Scenario Setup

- **Scenario:** setup as indicated in the *Compendium*, including *safe haven* tiles.
- **Galactic Event Cards:** shuffle the ones indicated in the scenario or all of them except 1T-2T-3T per cycle.
- **Houses**
 - **Available Houses:** use houses indicated in the scenario or use 14 *fallen house cards* for choosing.
 - **Players' Houses:** players choose a house to play from available houses.
 - **Focus Deck Adjustment:** for each player, check if a house focus card is absent; if so, remove it also from focus deck, re-drawing/re-shuffling as necessary.
 - **4 Fallen Houses:** choose (randomly or not) 4 unused houses to be the fallen ones. 1-3 must display a cracked glass on their fallen house cards.
 - **Fallen House Tiles:** if part of the scenario, randomly choose house(s) to be placed on the tile(s), with indicated initial corrupted population.
- **Technologies**
 - **Technology Tableau:** for each of the 4 chosen fallen houses, place corresponding 8 *basic +4-influence* (top) and *basic* (bottom) technologies on tableau. For 1/2P, return 3/2 randomly selected top cards (+4-influence) to the box.
 - **Galactic Board:** shuffle the 8 *improved* technologies and place 4 face-up on the galactic board, covered by the *improvement block tile*. Keep other 4 aside.
 - **Extra Combat Tiles:** for each *combatant* technology place corresponding *combat tile* under main one. (*Carrier, Destroyer, Dreadnought, Sentry, Starbase*)



Player & House Setup

- **Player House Mat**
 - Give players a 2 glory token
 - Set player's influence board to 10.
 - Place a corruption on rightmost agenda slot.
 - Place 3 civilization trackers on leftmost space.
 - Check House's strategy and special powers.
- **Player's Deck**
 - Replace cards with House cards, if any.
- **Origin Card**
 - Choose one of the House's origin cards, A or B.
 - Place corresponding +4-influence tech on a top slot.
 - Leave *improved* tech card nearby.
 - 1-2P: remove *basic* tech card from the game.
 - 3-4P: add *basic* tech card to the tableau.
- **Home & Outpost Tiles:** set up as per the origin card.
 - Player/standard population die on home/outpost.
 - Indicated # cubes as active (right), rest as inactive.
 - Resource counter dials ('+' indicates exception).
 - Other elements depicted on the chosen origin card.
- **Initial Agenda:** flip origin card and install it on the leftmost agenda slot (without getting extra benefits).



Final Scoring

- **Player(s) Influence**
 - As accumulated on their influence board.
- **Voidborn Influence**
 - **60/100/140** for difficulty .
 - **30** for each *rift* still on the map.
 - **20** for each incomplete *safe haven*.
 - **20** for each *catastrophe token* used.
 - **10** for each harbinger on the map (not board).
 - **5** for each consumed technology card.
 - **5** for each ongoing crisis card on the board.
 - **3** for each fallen house card still on sectors.
 - **2** for each corruption marker on any sector. (regardless of who controls it), player's house mats, and agenda offer.
 - **1** for each population in voidborn sectors (but not sectors without fleet power).
- **Tie Breakers**
 - **Competitive:** influence > fewer corruption tokens on player mate + sectors > shared victory.
 - **Coop/Solo:** each player influence >= voidborn.

Combat

1. Approach Step

- **Approach Damage:** invaders & defenders inflict approach damage to each other simultaneously.
 - Sides usually inflict zero damage, unless modified (e.g.: *Sector Defense* installations = 1 damage per installation)
 - **Fallen Houses:** inflict approach damage as per their card (usually 2). If the player survives with 1+ fleet power, the player wins.
- **Approach Absorption:** invaders & defenders might avoid actual losses if they have approach absorption.



2. Salvo Step

- **Initiative:** each side calculates their initiative. If side has no fleet power left, initiative is zero.
- **Salvo Damage:** invaders & defenders inflict salvo damage to each other in initiative order.
 - Side with higher initiative deals one damage first. Then, if other side still has initiative after suffering damage, it also deals one damage.
 - If both sides have the same initiative, both inflict one damage to each other simultaneously.
 - Sides might inflict more than one salvo damage, depending on technology/ship. (e.g.: *Destroyer* = 1 damage per destroyer fleet power, once)
 - If at the end of the salvo step both sides still have fleet power, they do one more salvo step, and so on, until at least one side is out of power.
- **Salvo Absorption:** both sides might avoid actual losses if they have salvo absorption.
 - Absorption can be used only once per combat, unless stated otherwise.



Skirmish

- **Voidborn Fleet Power**
 - # corruption on civilization tracks + agenda slots (but not sectors or agenda offer)
 - + 1 if cycle 2 or 3
 - + leftmost extra power showing on crisis board
 - + (if any) extra power on crisis or war alert card
 - Voidborn tries to invade even with 0 (makes sense only for coop, when *defending* might count)
- **Target Sector**
 - Adjacent to voidborn sector or edge harbinger.
 - Non-Home and not immune to voidborn fleet.
 - **Priority:** can win > can tie > player recalls the most > pure > highest population > most guilds > random.
- **Outcome**
 - **Voidborn Win:** if the player has zero fleet power, even if voidborn also has zero fleet power.
 - Player discards any one of their glory tokens.
 - Remove the remaining voidborn fleet.
 - Perform *Abandon Sector*.
 - **Defense Effect:** if player did not lose, apply defense effect on the war alert / crisis card.



Combat Outcomes

Defender Victory

- **Condition:** only the defender has fleet power.
- **Awards:** nothing is awarded to the defender.

Tie

- **Condition:** both sides have zero fleet power.
- **Glory Token:** defender (if player) discards any one of their tokens.
- **Voidborn Control:** see *Abandoned Sector*.



Invader Victory: Voidborn Skirmish

- **Condition:** only the voidborn has fleet power left after a skirmish (see *Skirmish*).

Invader Victory: Player Invasion

- **Condition:** only the player has fleet power left after an *Invasion*. Take the steps below in any order.
- **Installations:** remove all installations (but not guilds).
- **Bounty & Reclaim Tokens:** resolve each token, and keep by the board for possible usage / influence.
- **Glory Tokens:** take all tokens, and gain influence equal to the sum of all glory tokens in your possession, even if no new glory token was gained in this invasion.
- **Harbinger:** place it on the crisis board as usual.
- **Rift:** gain 5 resources or remove a corruption, and flip the tile. Set population to 1, without corruption.
- **Resolve:** perform (once) after an invasion.
- **Fallen House:** place House card by the player board to use it as a 6th technology slot. Choose one of the 2 house technologies if it's available on the tableau.



Abandoned Sector

- **Condition:** when last fleet power is removed from a Non-Home sector due to:
 - Lost *Skirmish*
 - Combat tie
 - Recalling last fleet power (e.g.: as a cost)
 - Voluntary move for *Invasion*
 - ...but not when *Regrouping*, as it's not allowed
- **Voidborn immediately takes over as much as it can**
 - Remove all installations (but not guilds).
 - Place corruption under population, unless it cannot be corrupted or has no population at all. (e.g.: *Paradise World*)
 - Place voidborn fleet with 2 power, unless it's immune to voidborn fleet. (e.g.: *Survivor's Colony*)
 - Place face-down bounty token.

